## SIP AND SAVOUR

The success of aged Indian whiskies already tells a story about the industry maturing and also of innovation waiting to be unleashed.

**These are a few trends that stand out:**

**Increased Cask Experimentation** The use of sherry, port, and wine casks is expected to increase, bringing further richness to aged Indian malts.

**Sustainable Aging Practices** Distilleries are investigating low-impact, climate-friendly ageing procedures to reduce evaporation losses while preserving quality, given the rise in climate-related concerns.

**Global Recognition** A limited number of editions and premium-aged releases of Indian whisky are claiming great demand outside the country due to India's status as a whisky giant and its rising fame internationally.

OBJECTS OF DESIRE
**WHISKY**




Much sought after as a collector's item, the price of the Expedition at more than US$ 12,000 (₹10.3 lakh approx.) is reminiscent of a twist of fate moment, as Indian makers were once frowned upon as a haven of cost-effective, unrefined products.

The usual price of a 15YO single malt whisky (like Glenfiddich 15 or The Macallan Double Cask 15) falls within the $80-$150 (₹6,900-12,956) category, though Amrut's 15-year-old single malt is far costlier. Retailing at $12,000 (₹10.3 lakh approx.), Amrut has likened its latest release to a 1940, 70-Year-Old Generations.

Here's what contributes to this significant price difference.

**Accelerated Maturing** Given the extreme hot-and-humid climatic conditions in India, whisky is maturing at a faster rate due to which the desired flavours develop quicker. So, a 15 years old Indian whisky is as complex as a much older Scotch whisky.

**High Evaporation Rates** The temperate climate also accounts for high evaporation rates, causing the angel's share to be as high as 12% per year. Thus, there is a decline in production and scarceness of old models.

**Limitation of production** The uniqueness of an aged 15-year-old Indian single malt available in a limited edition attracts collectors, promoting investor demand and supporting a premium price.

Compared to the West, India has its own unique set of challenges and opportunities when it comes to ageing whisky, in comparison to Ireland and Scotland; the warmer and more humid Indian climate accelerates the maturity of whisky. India's annual evaporative rate is significantly higher than Scotland's, where the 'angel's share' is around 9-12%, versus Scotland's 2-4%. Therefore, does an Indian whisky acquire the complexity of a higher-aged whisky as a Scotch whisky? Considering that Indian whisky takes just 15 years to age, the rapid ageing process could equate to the depth and complexity found in a 40-year-old Scotch.